VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

FRIDAY, NOVEMBER 13, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

One word for Jensen Huang, and a $74 billion pitch for SpaceX's neighbors

Hours after Nvidia's board announced that Jensen Huang had resigned, Elon Musk agreed with Naval Ravikant that "one does not just simply replace the founder," shared Tim Sweeney's lament for "a sad day for NVIDIA," and overnight posted a single word, "Jensen," over a video tribute. It was his most-liked post of the day. He also amplified SpaceX's case to the towns around its two planned supercomputer campuses in Texas and Arizona: more than $74 billion of investment, $220 million for Brownsville's water and a cleanup of decades of illegal dumping. Bloomberg reported that SpaceX and Tesla could announce a merger as soon as December. Musk shared the naming of Ship 42, which is set to fly on Starship Flight 15 this evening, and talked up Grok Bot's new reach into Mac apps and X's 20-image posts.

I · NVIDIA

"Jensen": Musk's tribute after Huang resigns

Nvidia's board accepted its co-founder's resignation on Thursday morning. Musk sided with those who say founders cannot be replaced.

33
Years Huang led Nvidia, per interim CEO Colette Kress

−4.3%
Nvidia's close Thursday, after falling as much as 16%

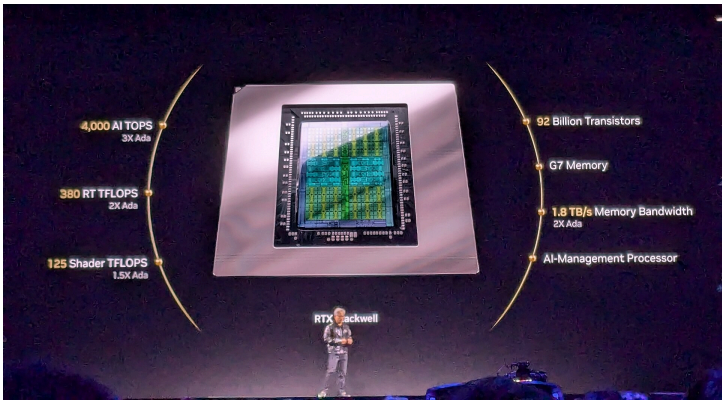
86,000+
Likes on Musk's one-word "Jensen" post by Friday morning

At 8:49 a.m. EST Thursday, Nvidia's newsroom posted "NVIDIA announces CEO transition." The release says Huang resigned as president, CEO and board member "effective immediately." Chief Financial Officer Colette Kress will run the company as interim CEO while keeping her finance job until a permanent successor is named. Kress said she is "committed to building on the extraordinary foundation Jensen created over the last 33 years."

The exit followed Huang's admission on Sunday that he had been unfaithful to his wife, reports that US intelligence suspected the businesswoman involved of being a Chinese agent, and a New York Times report of a second relationship with an executive who reported to him, NBC News recounted. The stock fell as much as 16% before closing down 4.3%.

ON THE WIRE

First chair. Harvey C. Jones, a former Synopsys CEO, becomes the first chair of Nvidia's board, according to the company's release.



Jensen Huang introduces RTX Blackwell GPUs at Nvidia's keynote at CES 2025 in Las Vegas, Jan. 6, 2025.

PHOTO: PRONOIA / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0 (CROPPED)

"True words"

Early Thursday, investor Naval Ravikant had written: "You'd think we'd have learned from Steve Jobs and Travis Kalanick that one does not just simply replace the founder..." Musk

replied "True words" at 12:44 p.m. EST, about four hours after the announcement.

At 5:51 p.m. he reposted Epic Games CEO Tim Sweeney's reaction from that morning:

> *"A sad day for NVIDIA, developers, America, and all humanity. Jensen founded and ran one of the few companies to reach a massive scale while driving massive continued innovation and ubiquity, while others fell into the trap of ever-increasing extraction."*
> TIM SWEENEY · 9:31 A.M. EST THURSDAY

One word, most-liked

Venture firm Andreessen Horowitz (@a16z) posted a video clip at 6:14 p.m. EST captioned "You're gonna be remembered forever because some things are eternal." Musk quoted it at 12:51 a.m. EST Friday with one word: "Jensen." It drew more than 86,000 likes by Friday morning, far ahead of anything else he posted in the day. On Wednesday night, as the board met, he had answered a call to hire Huang with "That would be an honor."

Blackwell chips in Chinese models

Former OpenAI researcher Will DePue posted at 4:29 p.m. EST what he called "conclusive forensic evidence" that the top four Chinese AI labs, DeepSeek, Moonshot, MiniMax and Ant Group, "have built their newest models on NVIDIA's most advanced Blackwell chips, which are barred from export to China." He says a model's starting weights carry a pattern unique to the GPU and seed that created them, and that traces survive training. Searching more than six trillion combinations, he matched six models, including DeepSeek-V4-Pro, Kimi K3 and MiniMax-M3, to Blackwell systems, and a Blackwell B300 reproduced DeepSeek-V4-Flash's starting weights "bit for bit." He estimates the two largest runs used 2,000 to 3,000 Blackwell GPUs each. Musk replied at 7:38 p.m. with a thinking-face emoji.

II · SPACEX & COMPUTE

"SpaceX community benefits"

SpaceX set out what Brownsville and Cochise County get from its supercomputer campuses, and Musk spent the day and night amplifying it.

$74B+	$220M	444
Planned investment in the Texas and Arizona campuses	SpaceX's commitment to Brownsville water and wastewater	Acres moved from Brownsville to the City of Starbase

At 11:08 a.m. EST Thursday SpaceX posted that it is "committed to making sure the communities where we build share in the benefits," linking a long update. Two minutes later Musk quoted it: "SpaceX community benefits." Over the next 17 hours he reposted three more SpaceX posts and two supporters' summaries of the plan.

The update describes two projects that together represent "more than $74 billion in planned American investment": a supercompute facility at Starbase in the Rio Grande Valley and a second campus in Cochise County, Arizona.

Starbase: $24 billion, its own power

SpaceX plans to invest up to $24 billion in the Starbase facility, on company-owned land near the Port of Brownsville and the city landfill, on top of more than $15 billion already spent on Starship and related infrastructure. It says the project has already generated more than 3,000 construction jobs and will support more than 500 permanent ones, and that the site will generate its own electricity "rather than drawing power from the public grid."

$220 million for Brownsville's water

The company has committed $220 million to expand water and wastewater infrastructure for Brownsville and Cameron County, "the largest private contribution to Brownsville's water future in the city's history," and has already given $40 million to the Brownsville Public Utilities Board. The money closes a funding gap for projects that would add about 20 million gallons a day from sources independent of the Rio Grande: 8 million through potable reuse and 12 million through brackish-groundwater treatment. The city and utility keep ownership, and SpaceX says it is "not acquiring water rights, prepaying utility rates, or receiving preferential access." Musk reposted SpaceX's water post at 1:08 a.m. EST Friday.

Sixty years of dumping

As part of the water deal, Brownsville disannexed about 444 acres of remote land to the City of Starbase. Parts of it were used for unauthorized dumping dating back to the 1960s, and SpaceX says it is removing "scrap metal, discarded appliances, old tanks, fiberglass insulation, construction materials, and thousands of illegally dumped tires." Musk reposted SpaceX's cleanup post at 3:56 p.m. EST, and at 12:54 a.m. Friday reposted a supporter's summary: "The first job on site was cleaning up sixty years of other people's trash."

BY THE NUMBERS

$24 billion	Planned SpaceX investment in the Starbase supercompute facility, per the company's update
$40 million	Already provided by SpaceX to the Brownsville Public Utilities Board, per the company's update
20 million	Gallons a day of new water capacity for the Brownsville area, independent of the Rio Grande, per SpaceX
26	Starlink V3 satellites aboard Starship Flight 15, per SpaceX's mission page

Cochise County: $50 billion, dry cooling

In Arizona, SpaceX is seeking to build a roughly $50 billion campus expected to create about 5,500 construction jobs and 1,000 permanent jobs. Working with local electric cooperatives, it says the project could cut members' electricity bills "by up to 20%," and it will use dry cooling "with no planned industrial groundwater use or new wells." Musk reposted Sawyer Merritt's summary of the Arizona benefits at 11:54 a.m. EST, and at 4:34 a.m. Friday reposted SpaceX's post: "From the Rio Grande Valley, TX to Cochise County, AZ, we're building more than supercomputers."

Taxes and tourism

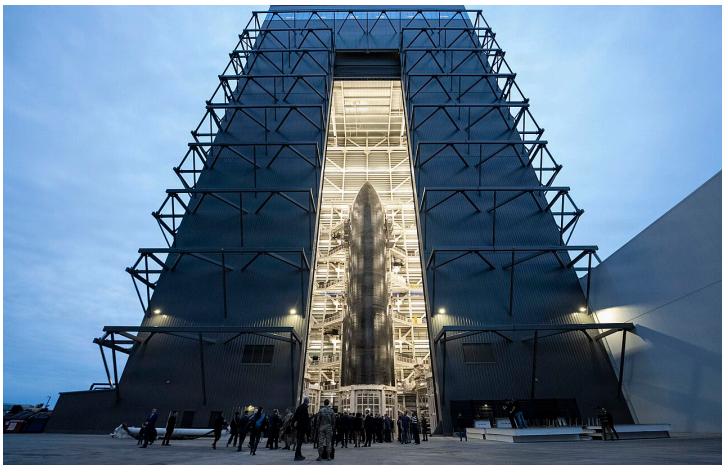
SpaceX says its Starship work has created nearly 5,000 jobs at Starbase, "the vast majority filled by people from the local community," and that Brownsville has reported nearly $100 million in launch-related tourism. It is also negotiating tax agreements with the City of Starbase and Cameron County, arguing that computing equipment depreciates so fast that a "properly structured tax abatement, paired with negotiated payments to local governments" gives towns a steadier revenue stream than a short-lived spike in taxable value.

Starshield limits disputed

Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Thursday that Starshield, the military version of SpaceX's Starlink service, again stops working on Ukrainian drones above 161 kilometers per hour (100 mph) in Russian-occupied parts of the country. "This directly affects our ability to intercept Russian jet-powered Shahed drones," he said at the European Political Community summit in Ireland, Ars Technica reported. SpaceX's media relations team told Ars: "This is false. There has been no change." Musk said last month that "Starshield systems are owned and controlled by the US government. Any limits on speed or usage are decided by the US military and ultimately POTUS." A European Commission spokesperson called restrictions on Ukraine's use of Starshield "unacceptable" if confirmed.

Flight 15 tonight, and a ship named "Don't Panic"

Starship Flight 15 is set to launch from Starbase as soon as 5:45 p.m. EST Friday, pending regulatory approval, SpaceX's mission page says. It is planned as the first flight to return both the Super Heavy booster and the Starship upper stage to the launch site for catch, with 26 Starlink V3 satellites aboard and a flight of more than 22 hours before the ship comes home. Each V3 satellite adds 1 terabit of capacity, so the 26 together equal about 10 Falcon 9 launches of the older V2 Mini satellites, and three carry cameras to inspect the ship's heatshield before it commits to the return.



Ship 39 stands inside Megabay 2 at Starbase, Texas, Jan. 12, 2026. Flight 15 flies a newer vehicle, Ship 42.

PHOTO: U.S. NAVY / PETTY OFFICER 1ST CLASS ALEXANDER KUBITZA · PUBLIC DOMAIN

At 12:56 a.m. EST Friday Musk reposted a fan's note that "Ship 42 has a name": "DON'T PANIC," from the cover of the guide in Douglas Adams's *The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy*, the book in which 42 is "the Answer to Life, the Universe, and Everything." The same words were on the dashboard of Musk's Tesla Roadster, the post noted.

Five minutes earlier he had reposted a pre-flight video edit built around a line of his from 2014: "If something's important enough you should try. Even if the probable outcome is failure."

III · SPACEX & TESLA

Merger talks advance, with December in view

Bloomberg reported that Musk's two largest companies are working through terms for what would be the biggest deal ever.

SpaceX and Tesla are progressing in merger negotiations and could announce the combination "as soon as in December," Bloomberg News reported at 3:22 p.m. EST Thursday, citing people familiar with the matter. The companies have also discussed a scenario in which an announcement slips into early 2027, and their boards and advisers are working out the terms of the tie-up and the governance of the combined company.

One open question is how to keep Tesla's business in China separate from SpaceX's government and defense contracts, The Verge noted. The companies are also discussing how many SpaceX shares Tesla investors would receive, Investing.com reported, putting SpaceX's market value above $1.9 trillion and Tesla's at about $1.5 trillion, so a combination would be worth more than $3.4 trillion. Musk last month called the proposed merger a "good idea," CNA reported; neither company could immediately be reached for comment.

QUICK HIT

Cybertruck poll. A day after extending Cybertruck production through the end of summer 2027, Musk reposted a video asking followers whether they support "Cybertruck Retiring Early for Cybercab" at 1:04 a.m. EST Friday.

IV · X & GROK

Grok Bot reaches into the Mac

A day after its 1.0 launch, the AI agent gained access to Apple's built-in apps, and X began allowing 20 images in a single post.

At 1:28 p.m. EST Thursday the Grok Bot account announced: "Grok Bot on Mac can now use Messages, Mail, Notes, Reminders, Calendar, Location, and Contacts." Musk quoted it at 1:10 a.m. EST Friday with two words: "Grok Bot."

Each connection is switched on separately in the app's Connect Apps screen, followed by macOS permission prompts, The Mac Observer reported. Grok Bot can read conversations and send messages, search email and prepare drafts, read and edit notes, create and check reminders, use calendar information for scheduling, find and add contacts, and search for nearby places. A single request can draw on several apps, for example turning details from a conversation into a reminder. There is no confirmed timeline for the same features on iPhone or iPad. The app arrived in August for iPhone and Mac and reached version 1.0 this month, 9to5Mac noted.

Maye Musk's photo cleanup

Earlier, Musk's mother, Maye Musk (@mayemusk), wrote at 10:06 a.m. EST that she asked Grok Bot the best way to move 2,000 photos in Dropbox from Camera Uploads to folders: "She said, 'would you like me to do it for you?' I was surprised as I had booked out the week to start sorting through them, a painful task. She did it in five minutes." Musk quoted her at 12:57 a.m. Friday:

> *"Give Grok @Bot your most laborious tasks!"*
> ELON MUSK · 12:57 A.M. EST FRIDAY

QUICK HIT

The 2014 warning. At 1:16 a.m. EST Friday Musk reposted a video post revisiting his 2014 talk at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), where, it said, he "told the whole world exactly where AI was going," but the internet remembered only one word: "demon."

Twenty images per post

"You can now share up to 20 images in one post on X," Benji Taylor, head of design at X, posted at 7:18 p.m. EST Thursday, crediting a 20-photo post by Justin Bieber as "this great example." Musk reposted Taylor and Bieber shortly before 1 a.m. Friday, then an artist's ultra-wide carousel, billed as "the first 16K image shared on X," and a post by @AJamesMcCarthy: "Since apparently we can post up to 20 photos/videos now here are a bunch of mine."

ON THE WIRE

Seven connections. Grok Bot on Mac can now use Messages, Mail, Notes, Reminders, Calendar, Location and Contacts, the Grok Bot account announced.

Takeaways

1. Jensen Huang resigned from Nvidia; Musk's one-word "Jensen" was his most-liked post.
2. SpaceX pitched $74B+ of campuses, with $220M for Brownsville's water.
3. Bloomberg: a SpaceX–Tesla merger could be announced as soon as December.
4. Starship Flight 15, with Ship 42 "Don't Panic," targets 5:45 p.m. EST Friday.
5. Grok Bot on Mac now works in Messages, Mail, Calendar and more.

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @nvidianewsroom, @naval, @TimSweeneyEpic, @a16z, @willdepue, @SpaceX, @TheCaptainEli, @SawyerMerritt, @paranoidream, @anabology, @esherifftv, @Yuvelir_22, @bot, @mayemusk, @benjitaylor, @justinbieber, @doganuraldesign and @AJamesMcCarthy.

Nvidia · NBC News · SpaceX updates · SpaceX Flight 15 · Ars Technica · The Mac Observer · 9to5Mac · Bloomberg News · The Verge · Investing.com · CNA

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